

5.3.4

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Question

Solve for $x \in \mathbb{N}$ using matrices: $\det \begin{pmatrix} x+3 & -2 \\ -3x & 2x \end{pmatrix} = 8$

Solution

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} x+3 & -2 \\ -3x & 2x \end{pmatrix} = (x+3)(2x) - (-2)(-3x) \quad (1)$$

$$= 2x^2 + 6x - 6x \quad (2)$$

$$= 2x^2 \quad (3)$$

$$2x^2 = 8 \quad (4)$$

$$x^2 = 4 \quad (5)$$

$$x = \pm 2 \quad (6)$$

$$x \in \mathbb{N} \implies x = 2 \quad (7)$$